First the Branch, Then the Brook

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 8

From the fixed platform, the keeper showed the trapped branch. It held the old gate in the alternate-routing position. The crew could finally see that physical relationship directly. Lark recorded the before state. Nib traced the usual brook and alternate channel on the unchanged diagram.

“A branch with a very large consequence,” Nib murmured. “A consequence we have watched,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **note**

“Keep action and result on different lines,” Lark explained clearly. “The process page tells the keeper what to do. Our next observation tells us what happened afterward. A repair that sounds sensible still needs its result checked.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try branch, lift, if, then. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read and order the visible process steps,” Lark invited gently. “What happens to the branch before the supported gate is reset?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First lift the branch. Then set the gate.**

“Which action comes first?” Lark asked gently. “Does this process passage itself tell us the later result?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper removed the trapped branch and reset the gate on its supports. Nib stayed on the dry platform with the notebook. Water followed the usual channel again. Lark recorded that observed result separately from the repair action. They planned a later check rather than treating one moment of returning flow as every answer they might need.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write branch beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal now held before, action, and result. The branch-gate cause had been directly checked. A visitor could use that explanation, while questions the notes had never measured still remained open.